

Sébastien Montpetit

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🇨🇦 Canadian, French | 🗣️ French (mother tongue), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

CURRENT POSITION

Research Fellow (postdoc) *Department of Economics, University of Warwick* Sept 2024-

RESEARCH FIELDS

Applied microeconomics, public economics, economics of gender and the family

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics	<i>Toulouse School of Economics</i>	2018-2024
• Research visit	<i>Université du Québec à Montréal</i>	Summer 2023
• Research visit	<i>Vancouver School of Economics</i>	Fall 2022
M.A. Economics	<i>McGill University</i>	2017-2018
B.Sc. Economics	<i>Université du Québec à Montréal</i>	2014-2017
• International exchange	<i>Université de Liège</i>	Winter 2016

WORKING PAPERS

- A Welfare Analysis of Universal Childcare: Lessons From a Canadian Reform** (with Luisa Carrer and Pierre-Loup Beauregard). [Job Market Paper](#), submitted
 - [Best Paper Award 2024](#) (runner-up) of the *Canadian Labour Economics Forum*

Abstract: We assess the welfare impact of the introduction of universal daycare services in Québec in 1997. Unlike the standard sufficient-statistic metric, which assumes marginal changes in fiscal policy, our approach accounts for the non-marginal nature of the program and quantifies non-pecuniary benefits. Through a structural model of childcare demand, we estimate substantial welfare gains from the policy, yielding a Marginal Value of Public Funds (MVPF) above 3.5. Using the sufficient-statistic approach underestimates welfare gains by half. Counterfactual simulations and a difference-in-differences analysis suggest that increasing availability, rather than solely improving affordability, is crucial for the effective design of universal programs.

- Veiling and the Economic Integration of Muslim Women in France** (with Antoine Jacquet)
 - *Revise and Resubmit at Canadian Journal of Economics*

Abstract: This paper provides the first empirical evidence on the economic costs of wearing the Islamic veil and on motives for veiling in a secular Western country. Using French observational data rather than small-scale interviews, we demonstrate a significant negative correlation between veiling and economic participation, even conditional on the respondent's religious environment. Using a structural interpretation of a theoretical model of veiling and labor-market participation, we then disentangle the various motivations behind the joint decision to veil and to be economically active. Our findings indicate that veiled women are less economically active not due to religious preferences, but rather because of lower economic returns to integration. Additionally, our results emphasize the significance of personal religious motives in the decision to veil, rather than signaling piety to others.

3. **A Comment on “Vulnerability and Clientelism” (2022)** (with Hai Ma and Ardyn Nordstrom) in Brodeur et al. (2025) “The Reproducibility and Replicability of Economics and Political Science”, *Revise and Resubmit at Nature*

Abstract: This systematic and large-scale reproduction effort tests the reproducibility and robustness of economics and political science. We reproduced and conducted robustness analysis of 110 articles recently published in leading economics and political science journals. We found that over 85% of published claims were computationally reproducible. In robustness checks, our re-analyses lead to 72% of statistically significant estimates to remain significant and in the same direction, and the median reproduced effect size is the same as the originally published effect size (that is, 100% of the published effect size). Fourth, six independent research teams examined 12 pre-specified hypotheses about determinants of reproducibility and robustness. They found a negative relationship between reproducers’ experience and reproducibility, but no relationship between reproducibility and author characteristics or data availability.

WORK IN PROGRESS

4. **Behind the Veil of Origin: Revisiting the Impacts of the French Headscarf Ban in Schools**

Abstract: This paper studies the effect of prohibiting the wearing of the Islamic veil in schools on economic outcomes of Muslim women. Using a difference-in-differences design, I find that the directive to school principals to ban the veil in French schools in 1994 led to a large decline in schooling among affected cohorts. An analysis of mechanisms suggests that this negative impact of the ban operates through heightened perceptions of discrimination and mistrust of the French school system, rather than through changes in parental educational investments. I also show that misclassification of the treatment group in previous work introduces substantial bias. In the long run, affected cohorts display lower religiosity and similar integration levels in adulthood, suggesting a gradual assimilation towards the majority culture.

5. **Intergenerational Transmission of Violence: Perpetration and Victimization** (with Sonia Bhalotra, N. Meltem Daysal, Mathias Fjællegaard Jensen, and Thomas H. Jørgensen)

Abstract: Does violence victimization get transmitted across generations? Using Danish register data spanning four decades, we provide the first empirical evidence on the cycle of victimization beyond small-scale surveys. We document that the intergenerational transmission is substantial for both victimization and crime. Even though victimization has received less attention, it emerges as nearly as consequential as violent offending. Transmission is proportionally stronger for daughters, reflecting their lower baseline risks combined with sizable parental effects. Maternal pathways, and especially mother–daughter victimization transmission, are particularly robust to differences in family traits. Direct exposure—especially to maternal victimization—plays a central role in perpetuating the cycle of violence across generations.

6. **Are Climate Policies Marginal? A Welfare Evaluation of Environmental Reforms** (with Jean-François Fournel)

Abstract: Which investments in climate protection should policymakers prioritize? We develop a framework that combines the Marginal Value of Public Funds (MVPF) with structural models of demand for green technologies to evaluate the welfare impact of non-marginal changes in environmental regulations. Our approach allows us to trace the MVPF over the full policy spectrum using counterfactual simulations. This contrasts with the sufficient statistics approach which relies on constant elasticities and a “small policy changes” assumption in the evaluation of the policy’s effectiveness. We apply our methodology to the Canadian electric vehicle market, following Fournel (2025). We document

important nonlinearities in the cost-effectiveness of the Canadian electric vehicle incentive programs: subsidies deliver substantial social returns on the first dollars spent, but the diminishing welfare gains make large subsidies inefficient. At the currently available subsidies, we estimate an MVPF of 0.8, which indicates that the policy does not generate a dollar-for-dollar return on investment.

AWARDS AND GRANTS

Replication Grant	<i>Institute for Replication</i> , €1,623	2025
Best Paper Award (runner-up)	<i>Canadian Labour Economics Forum</i>	2024
CEA Student Travel Grant	<i>Productivity Partnership</i>	2024
TSE Job Market Fellowship	<i>Toulouse School of Economics</i>	2023-2024
Frontenac Scholarship	<i>Fonds de recherche Nature et Technologies Québec</i>	2018
Graduate Excellence Fellowship	<i>McGill University</i>	2017-2018
Coop-UQAM Scholarship	<i>Université du Québec à Montréal</i>	2016
Martial-Nkamani Scholarship	<i>Université du Québec à Montréal</i>	2015

RESEARCH AND TEACHING ASSISTANCE

Microéconomie 2 (undergraduate)	with. L. Bottega (TSE)	2021-2023
Causal Inference with Observational Data (graduate)	with M. Bobba (TSE)	2021
Introduction to Economics for Biologists (graduate)	with F. Salanié (TSE)	2020-2021
Economic Development II (undergraduate)	with F. Grimard (McGill)	2018
Research assistant	for F. Grimard (ISID, McGill)	2018
Money, Banking & Gov. Policy (undergraduate)	with N.M. Wasi Uddin (McGill)	2017

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

2025 :	TEPP (Rennes, scheduled), IFS (London, scheduled), Journées LAGV (Aix-Marseille)
2024 :	ENS de Lyon, McGill, Sherbrooke, SBCA (Washington), CEA (Toronto)
2023 :	Naples, CEA (Winnipeg), SCSE (Québec City), CIREQ PhD Conference (Montréal), Université du Québec à Montréal, Stockholm University
2022 :	ASREC Graduate Workshop (online)

REFEREEING SERVICES

Quarterly Journal of Economics, Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Development Economics, Canadian Journal of Economics, Agence Nationale de la Recherche

OUTREACH

Media	NY Times, Le Devoir, Le Monde, Les Échos, Radio-Canada Ottawa, 107.7fm Estrie, Zone Économie (Radio-Canada), 98.5fm Montréal
Academic	Childcarepolicy.net, Policy Impacts Library

REFERENCES

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